

The Job Seeker Poster Session at the 2026 APS Global Physics Summit is a new initiative during which students and early career scientists in the job market will showcase their skills and expertise to potential recruiters. **This is not a research poster. It is a professional positioning tool.** Your goal is to help employers quickly understand what problems you can solve and what skills and expertise you bring.

The main audience of this event are [conference exhibitors](#) (click on exhibitor list button at top left) and [employers participating](#) in the Career Fair. This means that it will largely be people from the private sector as well as a few national laboratories, so the **content of your poster should be tailored largely to industry roles**. Your job seeker poster will be different from a typical research presentation as it should tell a story about you as a candidate rather than about your research. **A traditional research poster explains a scientific contribution, while a job seeker poster explains why you are hireable.**

Some guidelines for building your poster:

- You can choose to focus on one research project or multiple projects/experiences, as long as these tell a story about your career path and are relevant to the types of roles you are seeking. You do not need to list every single thing you've done.
- You are encouraged to include some data/plots to showcase your technical skill as well as to show that you can tell a story with data. Avoid too many plots/results if they are not highlighting a specific area of expertise or skill.
- Include the skills you would bring to a prospective company/lab.
 - For example: programming languages, software, experimental techniques, project management, collaboration, leadership, mentoring, communication, etc.
 - Non-technical skills such as communication and collaboration tend to be extremely important in industry.
- Include how you have approached and solved problems in your research/work. For example, the poster can be organized with headings: Problem, Approach, Tools used, Outcome/impact for each project you choose to highlight.
- Take credit and specifically mention the work that you have done.
- Avoid too much jargon, as some company representatives might not be the actual hiring managers and may or may not have the background to understand technical details.
- Try to have a good mix of images and text, with bullet-lists rather than blocks of text where possible.

[Sample poster](#)

- Please note that this is only an example that is a bit more research heavy than what your poster might look like. This poster should not be directly copied or used as a template.
- Highlights: there are separate sections on Skills, Focus area, and Teaching/Mentoring experience; there are 3 research projects represented. You can choose to include one or more of these sections and they can be bigger or smaller depending on your experience and preference.
- *Many thanks to Dr. Farah Dawood, APS Program Lead for Inclusive Communities for sharing her own poster with us from a previous, similar event.*

Before You Print Checklist:

- ☐ Is it clear what roles you're seeking?
- ☐ Can someone understand your core skills in under 60 seconds?
- ☐ Have you clearly stated your personal contributions?
- ☐ Is jargon minimized?
- ☐ Does the poster visually guide the reader?

For any questions, please contact careers@aps.org or **stop by our virtual Office Hours:**

Monday, February 23, 1 - 3pm ET

Thursday, February 26, 1 - 3pm ET

[Join Zoom Meeting](#)

Meeting ID: 880 9027 7968

Passcode: 743510